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From St. Petersburg,

February 10, 1902.

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Secretary of State,

Washington.

The answer of Russian Minister for Foreign Affairs in regard to Manchuria says the Russian Government always desires to cultivate and extend the best relations with the United States, and is willing now to remove the anxiety at Washington caused by proposed arrangements in China, but it feels bound at the same time to declare that negotiations between two independent states are not subject to the approval of other states. No attack has been made upon the open door, as that principle is understood by Russia, and Russia does not intend to change the policy pursued by her heretofore. Any concessions granted to the Russian-Chinese Bank would be of the same character as those already granted under private agreement to many other foreign corporations, and it would be strange if the door that is open to other nations should be closed to Russia, whose frontier adjoins Manchuria. Russia has sent her troops into Manchuria to establish order in the interest of all nations. Russia has

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conquered Manchuria, but still maintains her firm determination to restore it to China and withdraw her troops as soon as the conditions of evacuation are settled and precautions taken against a recurrence of the difficulty. Nobody can deny to an independent state the right to grant such concessions as it is free to dispose of.

The Minister for Foreign Affairs has reason to believe that the demands of the Russian-Chinese Bank do not exceed those frequently made by other foreign corporations, and Russia cannot refuse to Russian companies the protection given by other states to syndicates and corporations of their own nationality.

The Minister for Foreign Affairs closes with a declaration that there is no intention on the side of Russia to depart from the assurances heretofore given as to the principles which invariably direct her policy.

T O W E R

Deciphered by JRB, Chief Clerk's Office, February 10, 4.50 P. M.